

Press Farm — Fermentation Program

Prepared for Chef Phil • Fall Planting Meeting • June 2026 *Press Farm, Yountville — Micheal Breedlove*

Everything below is built from what the farm grows now or can seed this fall. Two goals: ferments that earn a place on the menu, and jars that look good enough to live on a shelf in the dining room.

1. Menu Ferments — From Crops Already in the Ground (Summer)

Ferment	Farm crop	Menu application
Lacto cherry tomatoes	Tomatoes, garlic, basil	Whole on crudo, burst into vinaigrette, brine as a seasoning
Fermented hot sauce	Peppers	House condiment; pepper mash for compound butter
Dilly beans	Beans, dill (micro), garlic	Garnish, snack boards, Bloody Mary program at the bar
Half-sour cucumbers	Cucumbers	Burgers, tartare, boards
Fermented cucamelons	Cucamelons	Tiny "cornichons" — striking and ours alone
Fermented radish pods	Radish Pods / Tiny Radish Pods	Caper-like pop; we already sell the pods fresh
Nasturtium capers	Nasturtium Capers (already in catalog)	Already producing — expand volume for winter use
Fermented corn	Corn	Relish, salsa, soup garnish
Salsa verde ferment	Tomatillo, peppers, cilantro	Fermented tomatillo base — brighter and shelf-stable
Garlic scape paste	Garlic Scape	Compound butter, dressings; freezes/keeps in brine
Fermented squash + blossoms	Squash, Patty Pan, Squash Blossom	Relish; blossoms add color in the jar
Preserved lemons / citrus	Lemons, Yuzu, Kumquats, Calamansi	Salt ferment; yuzu kosho (yuzu zest + chile + salt) is a standout
Fermented green walnuts	Green Walnuts	Pickled walnut, ketchup-style condiment — old Napa tradition
Elderflower / hibiscus soda	Elderflowers, Hibiscus	Wild-fermented sodas and shrubs for the NA program
Shiso-pickled anything	Shiso	Red shiso dyes brines a deep magenta — flavor + color in one

2. Fall Ferments — What We Should Plant This Fall (the decision list)

These are the crops to commit seed and bed space to **at this meeting** if the ferment program is a go. All are fall-planted for late-fall/winter harvest, and all are already crops we know how to grow.

Plant now	Ferment	Menu application
Cabbage — green and red	Sauerkraut; red kraut with apple	Workhorse — braises, boards, plates. Red is the better color
Napa cabbage + daikon	Kimchi	Eggs, rice, fritters, family meal that migrates to the menu
Daikon + carrots	Đồ chua	Banh mi-style, fish dishes
Watermelon radish	Brined rounds	Concentric pink rings — top-tier garnish and jar
Beets (incl. Chioggia)	Fermented beets + beet kvass	Salads, garnish; kvass for the NA drinks list
Turnips + a beet per jar	Torshi (Lebanese pink turnips)	Mezze, sandwiches; the beet bleeds the whole jar pink
Carrots (rainbow)	Ginger or turmeric carrots	Slaws, garnish; turmeric makes them neon
Fennel	Fermented fennel with fronds	Charcuterie, fish
Cauliflower (colored varieties)	Giardiniera with carrot + pepper	Antipasto, sandwiches — and the best-looking mixed jar
Kohlrabi	Kraut-chi / brined batons	Crunchy garnish, slaw
Quince + Persimmon (orchard, no planting needed)	Fermented fruit + honey	Cheese boards, desserts, holiday menu

3. Decoration Jars — Built to Be Looked At

Ranked by how long they hold their looks on a shelf:

1. **Pink turnip torshi** — entire jar glows pink; holds color for months
2. **Red cabbage kraut** — vivid magenta, dense pack, classic crock look
3. **Beet ferments / kvass** — deepest ruby in the lineup
4. **Watermelon radish rounds** — pink ring pattern pressed against the glass
5. **Giardiniera** — multi-color confetti (colored cauliflower earns its keep here)
6. **Whole cherry tomatoes** — jewel tones suspended in clear brine
7. **Dilly beans** — packed vertical with dill fronds; clean, architectural
8. **Chioggia beet slices** — candy-stripe spiral against the glass
9. **Hot pepper mash** — small jars, deep red-orange
10. **Shiso-dyed jars** — anything brined with red shiso goes magenta

Display notes: - Beet, red cabbage, turmeric, and chile ferments hold color longest. Pale ferments (green kraut, fennel) go grey under direct light — keep those in the walk-in, show the colorful ones. - 2–3% salt brine + a glass weight keeps brine clear and everything submerged; surface exposure is what clouds a jar. - Active display jars need burping or airlock lids. For permanent decor, ferment fully, then refrigerate or display sealed past active fermentation.

4. Suggested Timeline

When	Action
Now–August	Run summer ferments (tomatoes, beans, cukes, hot sauce, corn, nasturtium capers, radish pods). Builds the program while fall crops grow
August–September	Sow brassicas, roots, daikon, napa, fennel for fall harvest
October–November	Harvest + big fermentation push: krauts, kimchi, torshi, giardiniera
November–December	Quince/persimmon/citrus ferments; display jars ready for holiday season
Winter	Menu runs on the fall pantry; preserved citrus + yuzu kosho mature

Decisions needed from this meeting: 1. Which fall crops get bed space for the ferment program (Section 2)? 2. Does Press want dedicated display jars in the dining room? If yes, we'll grow extra red cabbage, beets, watermelon radish, and colored cauliflower specifically for looks. 3. Volume targets — pantry for the kitchen vs. a few showcase jars vs. a real preservation program.